ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 48

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Lao Alphabet

ປຶ້ມ ກ ຂ ຄ ຂອງຂ້ອຍ

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 27 Lao Consonants and 19 Vowels with English Phonetics

ກ ຂ ຄ

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET. The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

My First Lao Alphabet — ປຶ້ມ ກ ຂ ຄ ຂອງຂ້ອຍ
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 48

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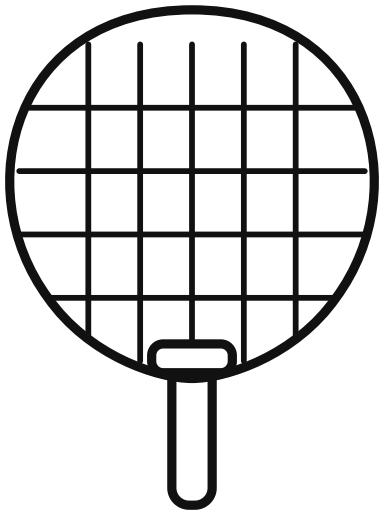
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Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

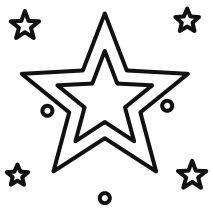
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A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

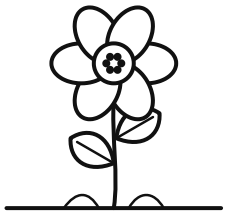


This book belongs to
ປຶ້ມຫົວນີ້ເປັນຂອງ

I started learning Lao on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 48 is Lao. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **Doubled vowels are long:** *aa* as in "father", *ii* as in "see", *uu* as in "moon", *ee* as in "they", *oo* as in "go". A single vowel is short and quick.
- **h after a letter** (*kh, th, ph*) means "add a puff of breath". *th* is never the English "th" of "the", and *ph* is never 'f'.
- **g, dt, bp** are sounds between English pairs: *g* (ก) is between g and k, *dt* (ต) between d and t, *bp* (บ) between b and p — like the k, t, p in "skip, stop, spin", with no puff.
- **ny** is the sound in "canyon"; **aw** is the vowel in "saw"; **eu** is 'oo' said with a smile; **ae** is the 'a' in "cat".
- **Tones** are not shown in the English letters. Lao has six tones: listen and copy!

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Lao name** written in Lao (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Lao phonetics* spells the letter with the vowel า the way Lao children do (ก + า = กา), and says whether it is a middle-, high- or low-class letter and what it sounds like at the end of a word. In Part 2 it shows each vowel sign with ก.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Lao as spoken in Vientiane.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Lao! ພາສາລາວ

phaa-saa laao — the Lao word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **7 million people** speak Lao, as their first or second language.[3]

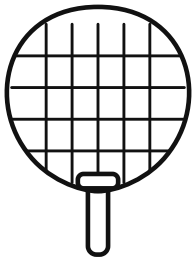
Where?
In **Laos**, along the great **Mekong River** in Southeast Asia, and by Lao families around the world.

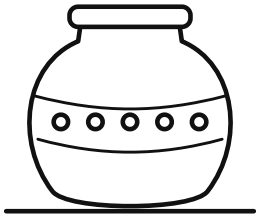
How is it written?
In the **Lao script**, from **left to right**, without spaces between words. Lao letters are round cousins of the Thai letters.

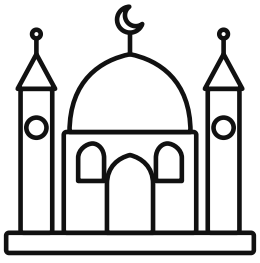
How many letters?
27 consonants, many vowel signs and tone marks. This book teaches the 27 consonants and **19 main vowels**.

Tones
Lao has **six tones**: the tune of a word changes its meaning. Listen carefully and copy!

Did you know?
Laos is the only country in Southeast Asia with **no sea coast**. Lao has its own numbers: ๐ ๑ ๒ ๓ ๔ ๕ ๖ ๗ ๘ ๙.







The Lao Alphabet ກ ຂ ຄ

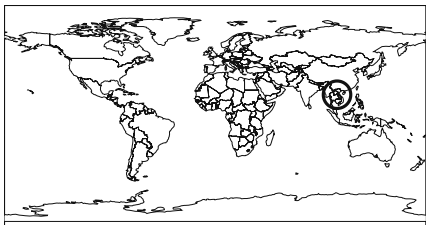
27 consonants — ພະຍັນຊະນະ

ກ *gaw gai*	ຂ *khaw khai*	ຄ *khaw khwaai*	ງ *ngaw ngua*	ຈ *jaw jawk*	ສ *saw seua*	ຊ *saw saang*
ຍ *nyaw nyung*	ດ *daw dek*	ຕ *dtaw dtaa*	ຖ *thaw thong*	ທ *thaw thung*	ນ *naw nok*	ບ *baw bae*
ປ *bpaw bpaa*	ຜ *phaw pheung*	ຝ *faw fon*	ພ *phaw phuu*	ຟ *faw fai*	ມ *maw maeo*	ຢ *yaw yaa*
ຣ *raw rot*	ລ *law ling*	ວ *waw wii*	ຫ *haw haan*	ອ *aw oo*	ຮ *haw heuan*	

19 vowels — ສະຫຼະ

◌ະ *sa-la a*	◌າ *sa-la aa*	◌ິ *sa-la i*	◌ີ *sa-la ii*	◌ຶ *sa-la eu*	◌ື *sa-la euu*	◌ຸ *sa-la u*
◌ູ *sa-la uu*	ເ◌ *sa-la ee*	ແ◌ *sa-la ae*	ໂ◌ *sa-la oo*	◌ໍ *sa-la aw*	ເ◌ຍ *sa-la ia*	ເ◌ຶ◌ *sa-la eua*
◌ົວ *sa-la ua*	◌ໍາ *sa-la am*	ໄ◌ *sa-la ai (mai ma-lai)*	ໃ◌ *sa-la ai (mai muan)*	ເ◌ົາ *sa-la ao*		

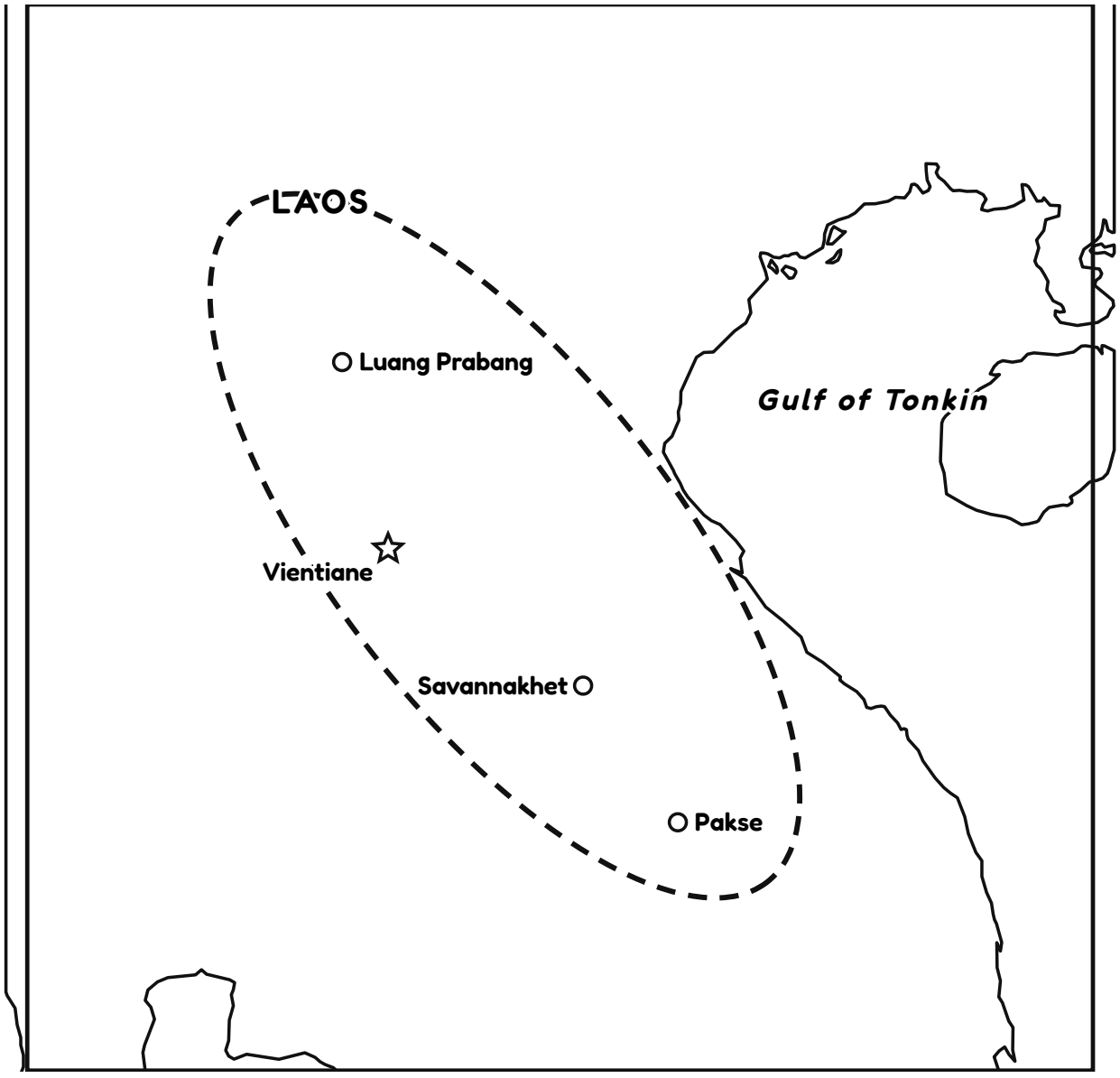
Read the consonants row by row, from ກ to ຮ — the same order as in this book. Then read the vowels.



The circle shows Laos on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Lao spoken?



Color it: the land where Lao is spoken (inside the dashed line) **yellow** · the rest of the land **green** · the sea **blue**. **Find it:** Vientiane ★, Luang Prabang, Savannakhet and Pakse all sit by the Mekong River. Draw the river in blue, from the north down to Pakse!

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PART 1

The Consonants ພະຍັນຊະນະ

pha-nyan-sa-na — “the consonants”

Lao has **27 consonants**. Lao children learn them in this order, each with its own **name word**: ກ ไก่ *gaw gai*, ຂ ไข่ *khaw khai*, ຄ ຄວาย *khaw khwaai*…

Our picture words

Many name words are animals or people (*chicken, buffalo, child…*). This book draws only objects, plants and nature, so for those letters we picked another word with the same letter. The page always tells you the real name word.

Three families of letters

Every consonant is **middle-class**, **high-class** or **low-class**. The class helps decide the **tone** of a word:

middle ກ ຈ ດ ຕ ບ ປ ຢ ອ · high ຂ ສ ຖ ຜ ຝ ຫ · low: all the others

Lao has tones!

Lao has **six tones** (in Vientiane), so the same sound can mean different things. Little marks above a letter help show the tone:

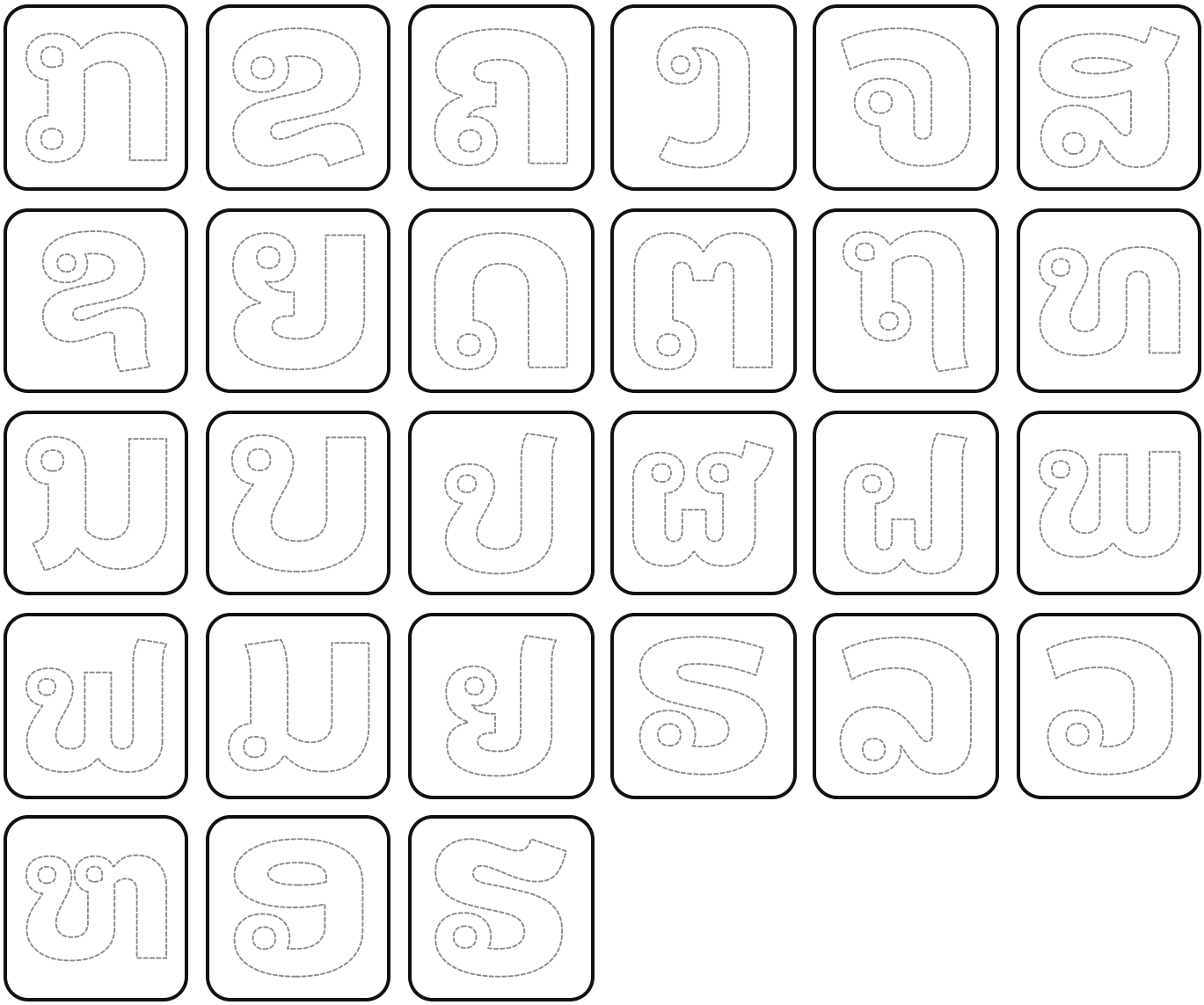
ก่ · ก้ · ก๊ · ก๋

The English letters in this book cannot show tones: listen to a Lao speaker and copy the tune!

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the consonants ພະຍັນຊະນະ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



ກ

NAME · ຊື່

ກໍ ໄກ່

gaw gai

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

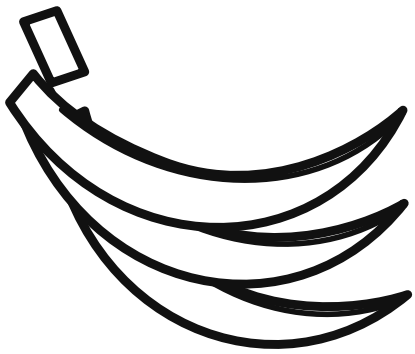
a hard ‘g’ — between the g in “go” and the k in “skip”

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ກ + ◌ = ກ◌

gaa · a **middle-class** letter · at the end of a word it says **-k**

Its name word ไก่ means “chicken”. We draw no animals, so our word is ก้วย.



ກ IS FOR

ก้วย

gúay

banana

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ຂ

NAME · ຊື່

ຂໍ ໄຂ່

khaw khai

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

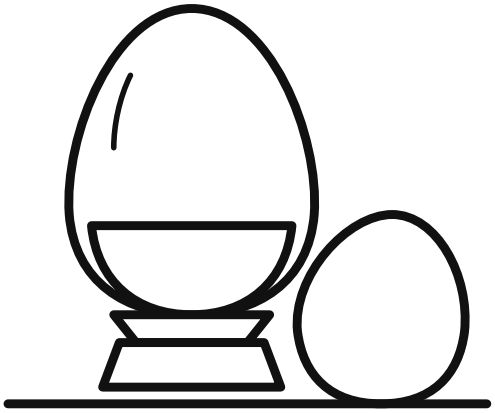
'k' with a puff of air, as in "kite"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ຂ + ◌ = ຂ◌

khaa · a **high-class** letter · at the end of a word it says **-k**

This is the letter's own name word: ຂໍ ໄຂ່!



ຂ IS FOR

ໄຂ່

khai

egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ຄ

NAME · ຊື່

ຄໍ ຄວາຍ

khaw khwaai

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

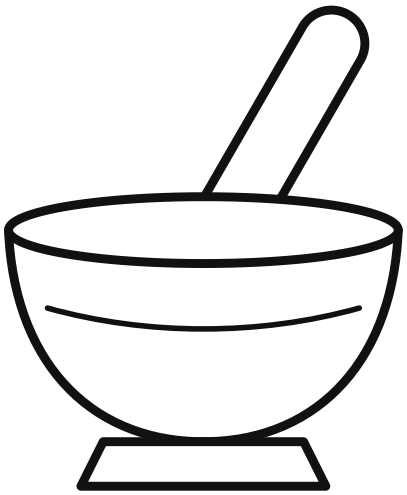
'k' with a puff of air, as in "kite"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ຄ + ◌ = ຄ◌

khaa · a **low-class** letter · at the end of a word it says **-k**

Its name word ຄວາຍ means "water buffalo". We draw no animals, so our word is ຄົກ.



ຄ IS FOR

ຄົກ

khok

mortar (for pounding food)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ງ

NAME · ຊື່

ງໍ ງົວ

ngaw ngua

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

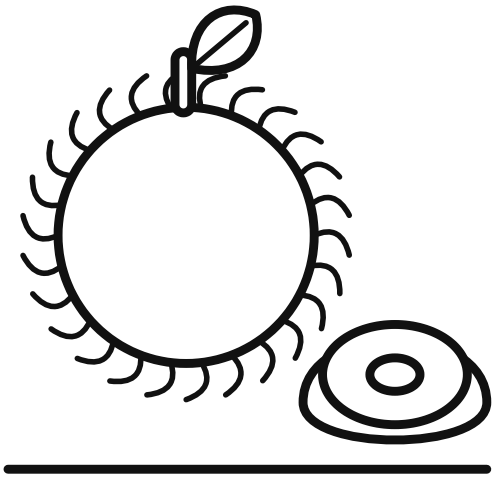
'ng' as in "sing" — but at the start of a word!

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ງ + ◌ = ງ◌

ngaa · a **low-class** letter · at the end of a word it says **-ng**

Its name word ງົວ means "cow". We draw no animals, so our word is ໝາກ ເງາະ: find ງ in the middle!



ງ IS FOR

ໝາກເງາະ

maak-ngaw

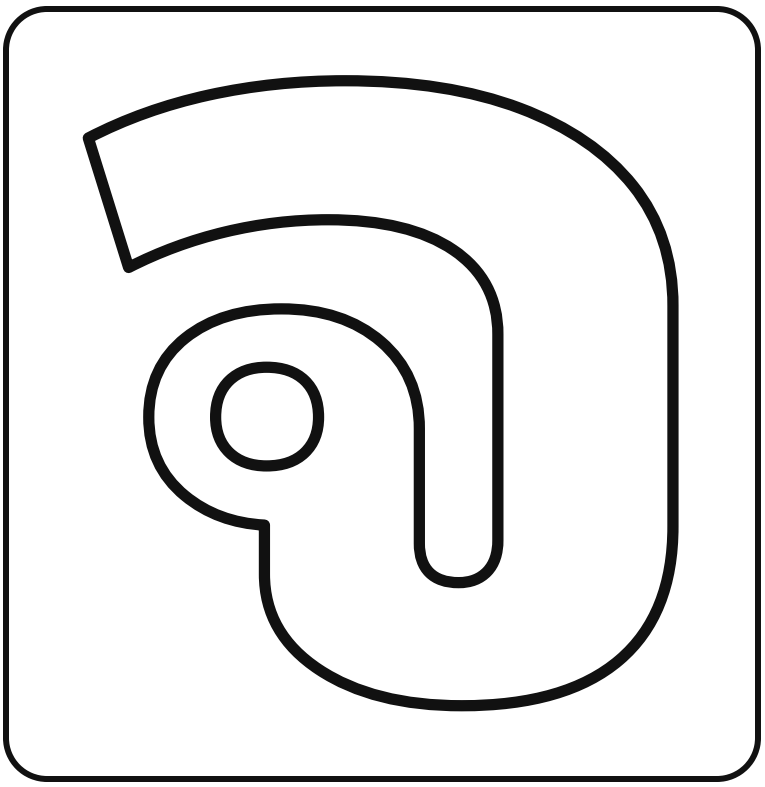
rambutan (a red, hairy fruit)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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NAME · ຊື່

ຈໍ ຈອກ

jaw jawk

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

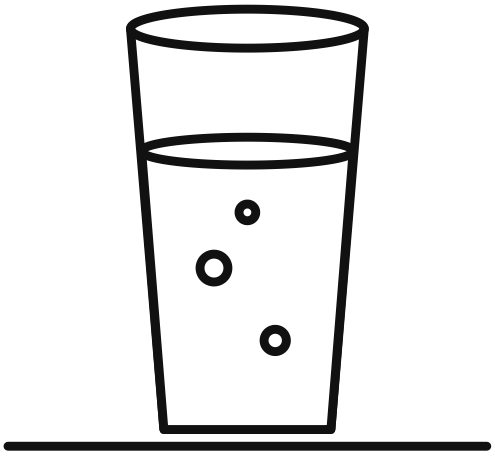
a soft ‘j’ as in “jam” (between j and ch)

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

จ + ◌ = จ◌

jaa · a **middle-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

This is the letter’s own name word: ຈໍ ຈອກ!



ຈ IS FOR

ຈອກ

jawk

cup, drinking glass

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

จ จ จ จ

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ສ

NAME · ຊື່

ສໍ ເສືອ

saw seua

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

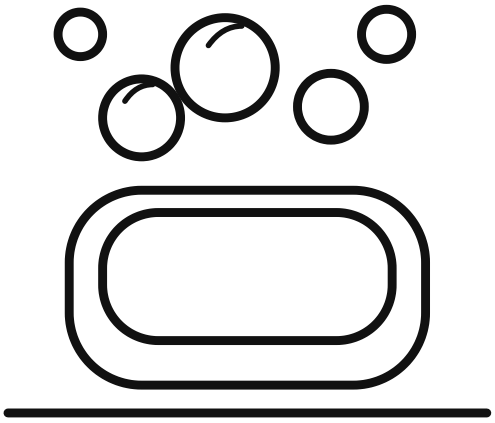
's' as in "sun"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ສ + ◌ = ສ◌

saa · a **high-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

Its name word ເສືອ means "tiger". We draw no animals, so our word is ສະບູ.



ສ IS FOR

ສະບູ

sa-buu

soap

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ຊ

NAME · ຊໍ

ຊໍ ຊ້າງ

saw saang

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun” (in Thai this letter says ‘ch’)

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ຊ + า = ຊา

saa · a **low-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

Its name word ຊ้างๆ means “elephant”. We draw no animals, so our word is ຊา.



ຊ IS FOR

ຊา

saa

tea

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ຍ

NAME · ຊື່

ຍໍ ຍຸງ

nyaw nyung

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

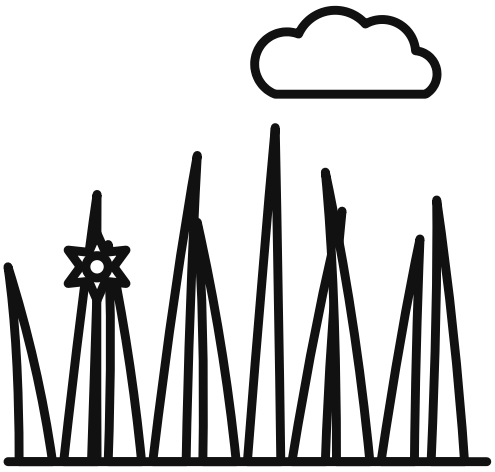
'ny' as in "canyon", said through the nose

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ຍ + ◌ = ຍ◌

nyaa · a **low-class** letter · at the end of a word it says **-y (like the end of "boy")**

Its name word ຍຸງ means "mosquito". We draw no animals, so our word is ຫຍ້າ.



ຍ IS FOR

ຫຍ້າ

nyaa

grass

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ດ

NAME · ຊື່

ດໍ ເດັກ

daw dek

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

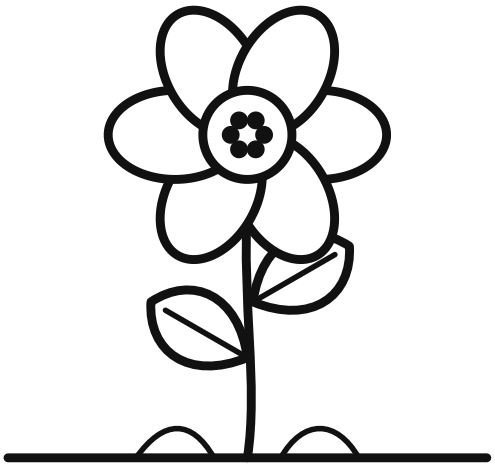
'd' as in "day"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ດ + ◌ = ດ◌

daa · a **middle-class** letter · at the end of a word it says **-t**

Its name word ເດັກ means "child". We draw no people, so our word is ດອກໄມ້.



ດ IS FOR

ດອກໄມ້

dawk-mai

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ດ ດ ດ ດ

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ຕ

NAME · ຊື່

ຕໍ ຕາ

dtaw dtaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

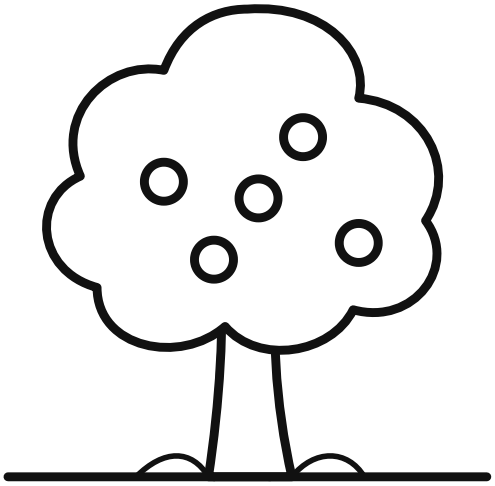
a hard ‘t’ with no puff of air, like the t in “stop”

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ຕ + າ = ຕາ

dtaa · a **middle-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

Its name word ຕາ means “eye”. We draw no faces or bodies, so our word is ຕົ້ນໄມ້.



ຕ IS FOR

ຕົ້ນໄມ້

dton-mai

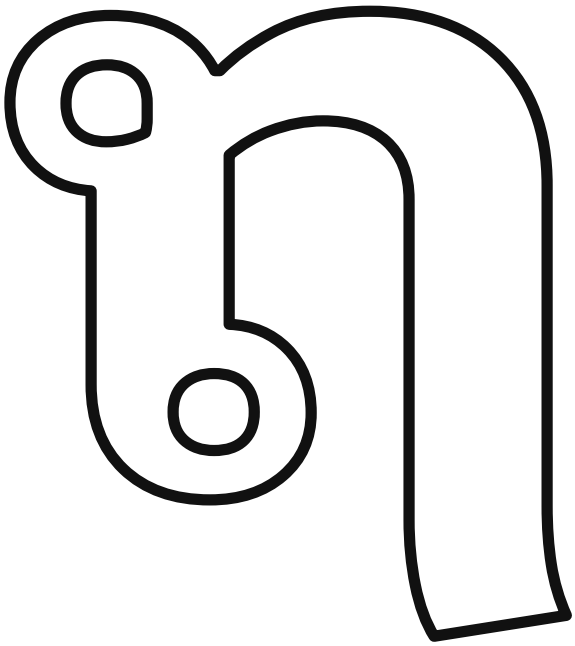
tree

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ຕ ຕ ຕ ຕ

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NAME · ຊື່

ຖໍ ຖົ

thaw thong

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

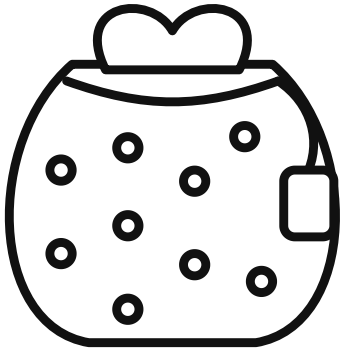
‘t’ with a puff of air, as in “top” (never the ‘th’ of “the”)

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ຖ + ◌ = ຖ◌

thaa · a **high-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

This is the letter’s own name word: ຖໍ ຖົ!



ຖ IS FOR

ຖົ

thong

bag

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ຖ ຖ ຖ ຖ

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ຫ

NAME · ຊື່

ທໍ ທຸງ

thaw thung

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

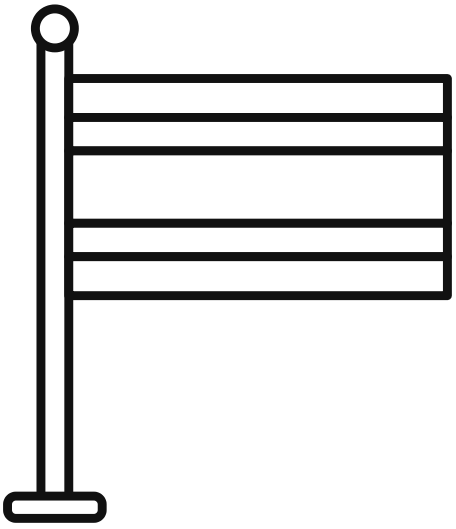
‘t’ with a puff of air, as in “top”

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ຫ + າ = ຫາ

thaa · a **low-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

This is the letter’s own name word: ທໍ ທຸງ!



ຫ IS FOR

ທຸງ

thung

flag

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ຫ ຫ ຫ ຫ

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ນ

NAME · ຊື່

ນໍ ນົກ

naw nok

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

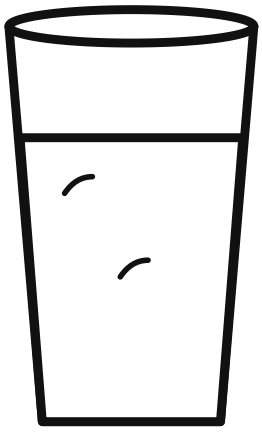
'n' as in "net"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ນ + ◌ = ນ◌

naa · a **low-class** letter · at the end of a word it says **-n**

Its name word ນົກ means "bird". We draw no animals, so our word is ນ້ຳ.



ນ IS FOR

ນ້ຳ

nam

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ນ ນ ນ ນ

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ບ

NAME · ຊື່

ບໍ ແບ້

baw bae

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

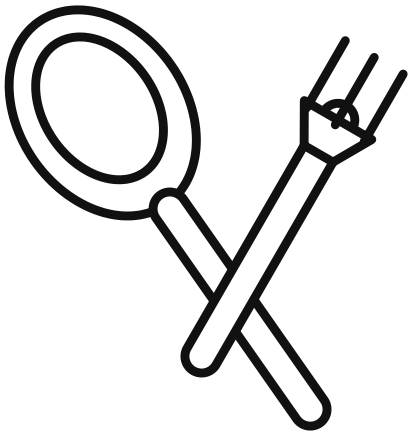
'b' as in "ball"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ບ + า = บา

baa · a **middle-class** letter · at the end of a word it says **-p**

Its name word ແບ້ means "goat". We draw no animals, so our word is ข่อๆ.



ข IS FOR

ข่อๆ

buang

spoon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ข ข ข ข

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ป

NAME · ຊື່

ປໍ ปา

bpaw bpaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

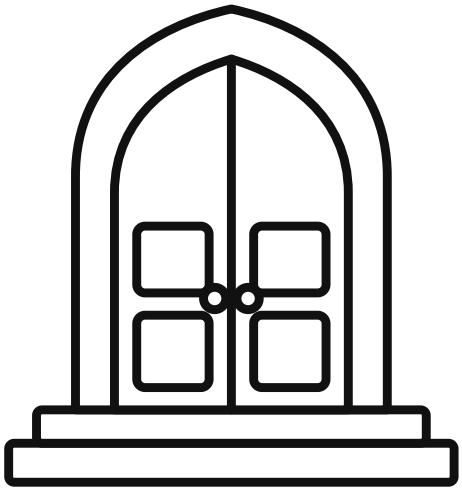
a hard ‘p’ with no puff of air, like the p in “spin”

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ป + า = ปา

bpaa · a **middle-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

Its name word ปา means “fish”. We draw no animals, so our word is ปะตู.



ป IS FOR

ปะตู

bpa-dtuu

door

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ป ป ป ป

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ຜ

NAME · ຊື່

ຜໍ ເຜິ້ງ

phaw pheung

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

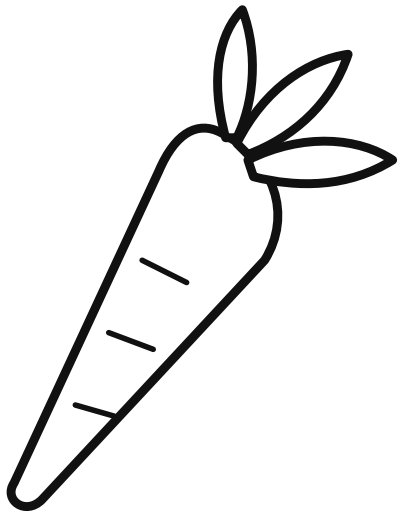
‘p’ with a puff of air, as in “pen” (never ‘f’)

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ຜ + ◌ = ຜ◌

phaa · a **high-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

Its name word ເຜິ້ງ means “bee”. We draw no animals, so our word is ຜັກ.



ຜ IS FOR

ຜັກ

phak

vegetables

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ຜ ຜ ຜ ຜ

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ฝ

NAME · ຊື່

ຝ ຝົນ

faw fon

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'f' as in "fan"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ฝ + า = ฝา

faa · a **high-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

This is the letter's own name word: ຝ ຝົນ!



ฝ IS FOR

ฝົน

fon

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ฝ ฝ ฝ ฝ

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ພ

NAME · ຊື່

ພໍ ພູ

phaw phuu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

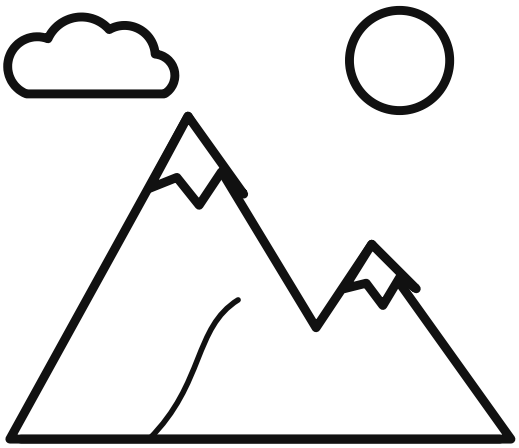
‘p’ with a puff of air, as in “pen” (never ‘f’)

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ພ + ◌ = ພ◌

phaa · a **low-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

This is the letter’s own name word: ພໍ ພູ!



ພ IS FOR

ພູ

phuu

mountain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ພ ພ ພ ພ

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ฝ

NAME · ຊື່

ฝ ໄฝ

faw fai

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'f' as in "fan"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ฝ + ฯ = ฝฯ

faa · a **low-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

This is the letter's own name word: ฝ ໄฝ!



ฝ IS FOR

ໄฝ

fai

fire

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ฝ ฝ ฝ ฝ

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ມ

NAME · ຊື່

ມໍ ແມວ

maw maeo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

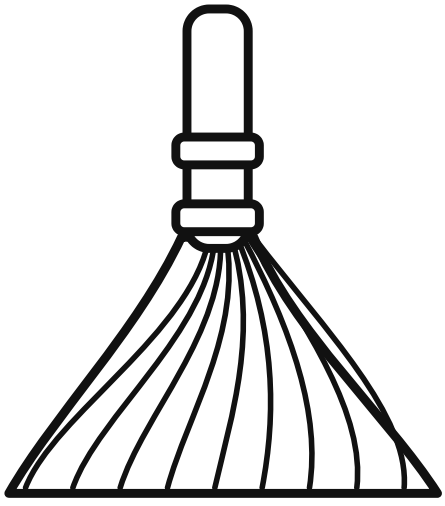
'm' as in "moon"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ມ + ◌ = ມ◌

maa · a **low-class** letter · at the end of a word it says **-m**

Its name word ແມວ means "cat". We draw no animals, so our word is ໄມ້ ກວາດ.



ມ IS FOR

ໄມ້ກວາດ

mai-gwaat

broom

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ມ ມ ມ ມ

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ຢ

NAME · ຊື່

ຢໍ ຢາ

yaw yaa

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

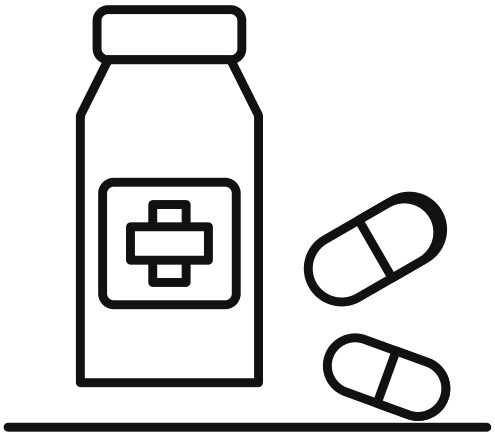
'y' as in "yes"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ຢ + າ = ຢາ

yaa · a **middle-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

This is the letter's own name word: ຢໍ ຢາ!



ຢ IS FOR

ຢາ

yaa

medicine

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ຢ ຢ ຢ ຢ

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ร

NAME · ຊື່

ຣໍ ຣົ໎

raw rot

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'r' as in "run" (many people say 'l')

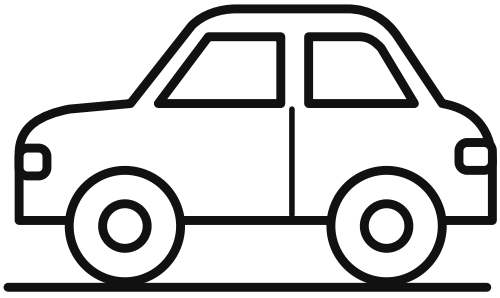
LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ร + ◌ = รา

raa · a **low-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

This is the letter's own name word: ຣົ໎.

Today 'car' is usually written ລົດ; ร is used mostly in names and borrowed words.



ร IS FOR

ຣົ໎

rot

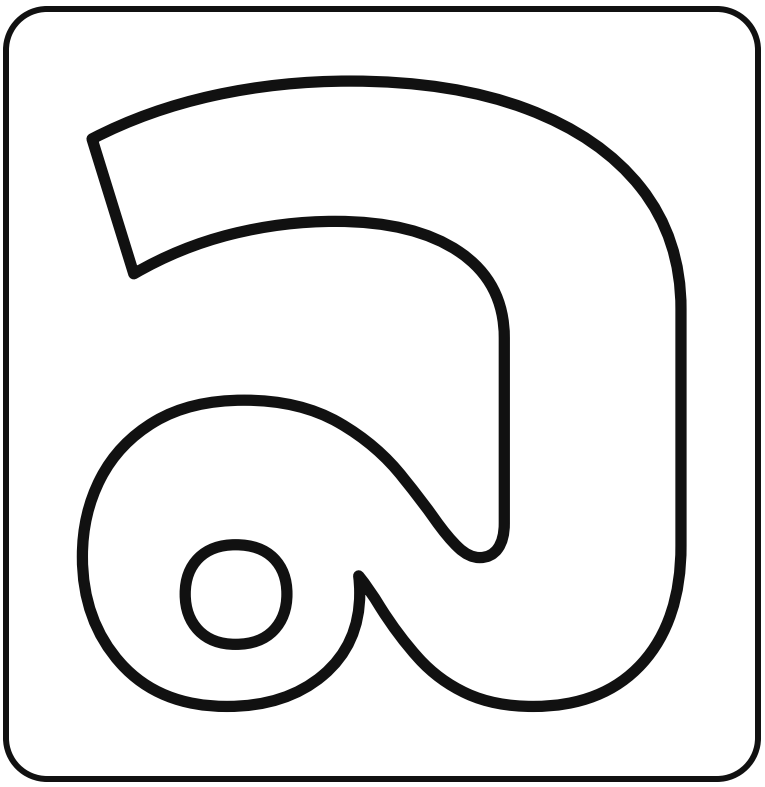
car

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ร ร ร ร

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NAME · ຊື່

ລໍ ລິ

law ling

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

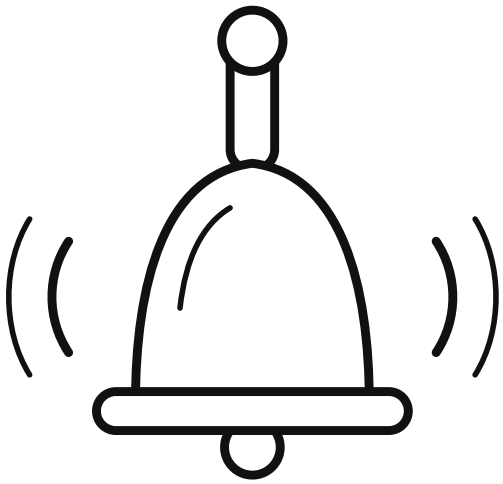
'l' as in "lamp"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ລ + ◌ = ລ◌

laa · a **low-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

Its name word ລິ means "monkey". We draw no animals, so our word is ລະຄັ.



ລ IS FOR

ລະຄັ

la-khang

bell

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ລ ລ ລ ລ

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ວ

NAME · ຊື່

ໂອ ວ

waw wii

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

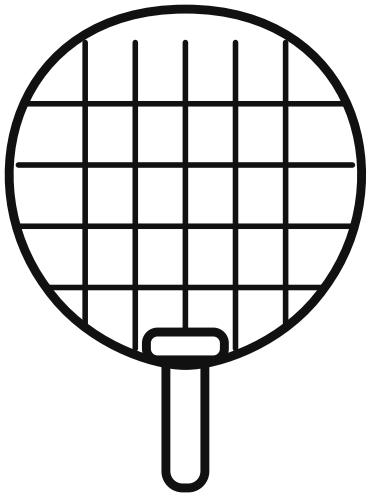
'w' as in "water"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ວ + า = ວา

waa · a **low-class** letter · at the end of a word it says **-w (like the end of "now")**

This is the letter's own name word: ໂອ ວ!



ວ IS FOR

ວ

wii

hand fan

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ວ ວ ວ ວ

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ຫ

NAME · ຊື່

ຫໍ ຫ່ານ

haw haan

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

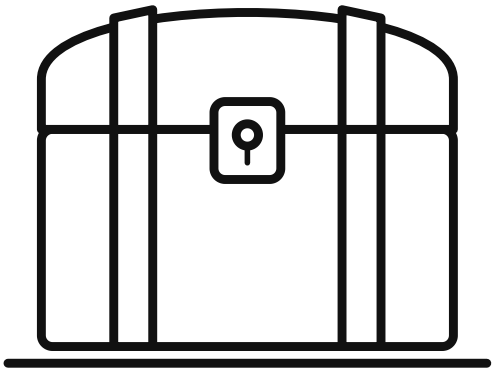
'h' as in "hat"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ຫ + າ = ຫາ

haa · a **high-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

Its name word ຫ່ານ means "goose". We draw no animals, so our word is ຫີບ.



ຫ IS FOR

ຫີບ

hiip

chest (a box with a lid)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ຫ ຫ ຫ ຫ

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ອ

NAME · ຊື່

ອໍ ໂອ

aw oo

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

no sound of its own: it holds a vowel at the start of a word

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ອ + ◌ = ອ◌

aa · a **middle-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

This is the letter's own name word: ໂອ!

You will meet ອ again in Part 2, holding the vowels.



ອ IS FOR

ໂອ

oo

bowl

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ອ ອ ອ ອ

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ຮ

NAME · ຊື່

ຮໍ ເຮືອນ

haw heuan

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

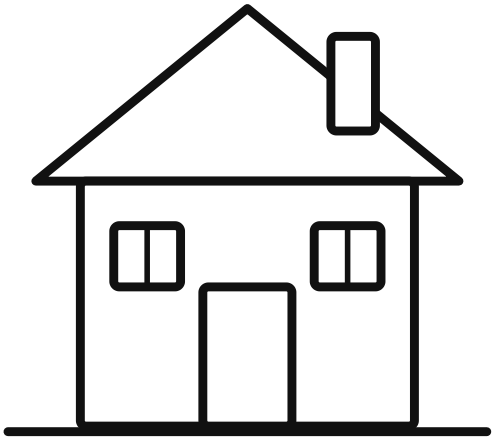
'h' as in "hat"

LAO PHONETICS · SPELLING & LETTER CLASS

ຮ + ◌ = ຮ◌

haa · a **low-class** letter · it is not used at the end of a word

This is the letter's own name word: ຮໍ ເຮືອນ!



ຮ IS FOR

ເຮືອນ

heuan

house

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ຮ ຮ ຮ ຮ

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PART 2

The Vowels ສະຫຼະ

sa-la — “the vowels”

Lao vowels are **signs** that sit around a consonant: **before** it, **after** it, **above** it or **below** it — and some go on two sides at once! This book has **19 main vowels**.

The silent holder

A vowel sign can never stand alone. To write a vowel by itself, Lao uses the silent letter ອ: ອ + ◌ າ = ອາ *aa*. Every big letter in this part is a vowel sign sitting on ອ.

Short and long

Many vowels come in pairs: a quick one and a long one, like ◌ິ *i* and ◌ີ *ii*. In the English letters, a **doubled vowel is long**.

Spell it like a Lao child

Put a consonant and a vowel together and read them as one:

ກ + ◌ າ = ກາ · ມ + ◌ ີ = ມີ · ດ + ◌ ູ = ດູ

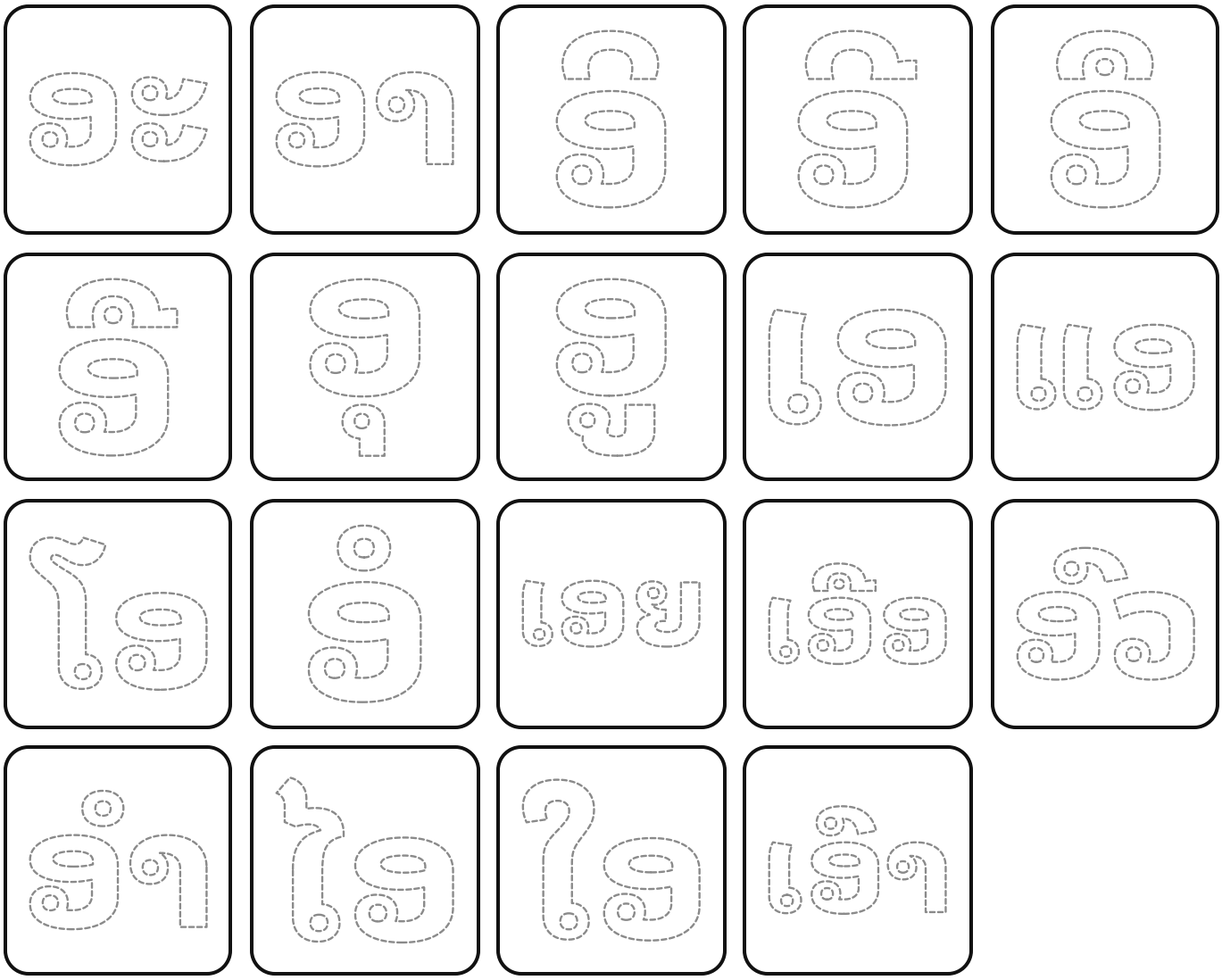
gaa · mii · duu

A few vowels change shape when a letter comes after them — the pages will show you how.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the vowels ສະຫຼະ

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



◌ະ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ອະ

sa-la a

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘a’ as in “cup”, cut off quickly

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ະ = ກະ

ga · short · the sign goes **after** the consonant



ອະ IS FOR

ກະຕ່າ

ga-dtaa

basket

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ລະ ລະ ລະ ລະ

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ອາ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ອາ

sa-la aa

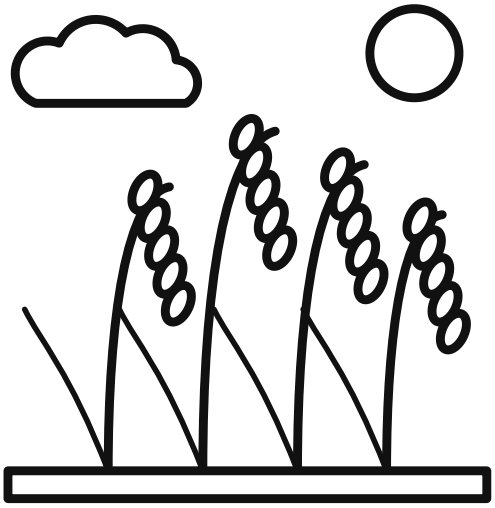
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a long ‘aa’ as in “father”

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌າ = ກາ

gaa · long · the sign goes **after** the consonant



ອາ IS FOR

ນາ

naa

rice field

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ອາ ອາ ອາ ອາ

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ິ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ອິ

sa-la i

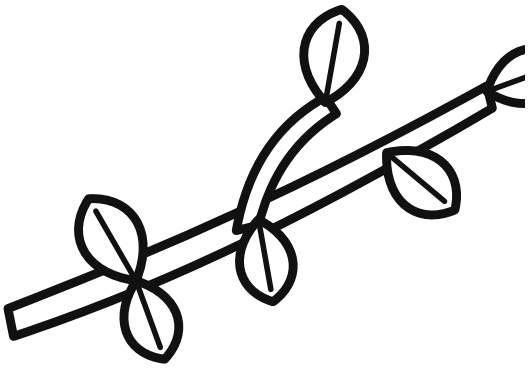
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘i’ as in “sit”

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ິ = ກິ

gi · short · the sign goes **above** the consonant



ອິ IS FOR

ກິ່ງໄມ້

ging-mai

branch

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ສ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ອີ

sa-la ii

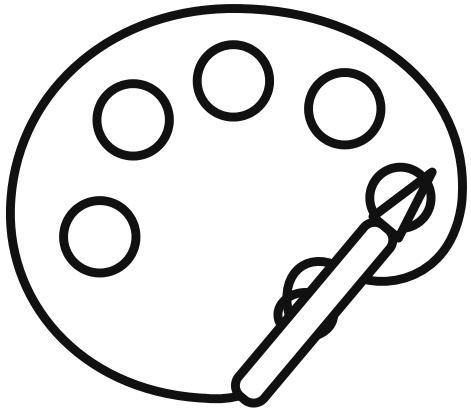
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a long ‘ee’ as in “see”

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ີ = ກີ

gii · long · the sign goes **above** the consonant



ອີ IS FOR

ສີ

sii

colours, paints

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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◌ິ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ອິ

sa-la eu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘eu’: say ‘oo’ with a big smile, lips not round

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ິ = ກິ

geu · short · the sign goes **above** the consonant



ອິ IS FOR

ປຶ້ມ

bpeum

book

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ອີ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ອີ

sa-la euu

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a long ‘euu’: the same smiling sound, held longer

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ີ = ກີ

geuu · long · the sign goes **above** the consonant



ອີ IS FOR

ຄີນ

kheun

night

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ອຸ

sa-la u

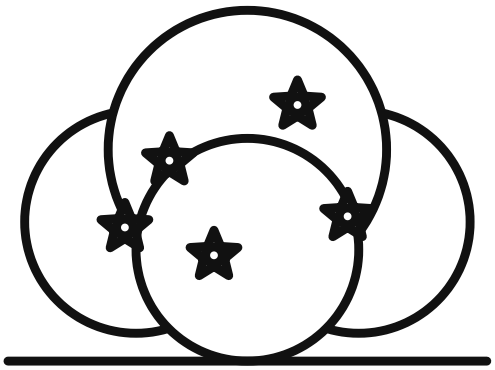
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a short ‘u’ as in “put”

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ຸ = ກຸ

gu · short · the sign goes **bold** the consonant



ອຸ IS FOR

ພຸ່ມໄມ້

phum-mai

bush

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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◌ູ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ອູ

sa-la uu

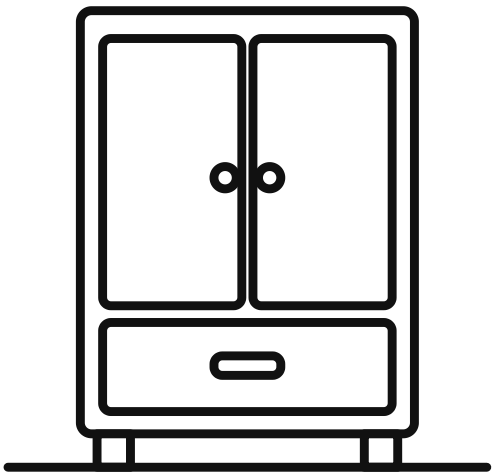
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a long ‘oo’ as in “moon”

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ູ = ກູ

guu · long · the sign goes **below** the consonant



ອູ IS FOR

ຕູ້

dtuu

cupboard

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ເອ

sa-la ee

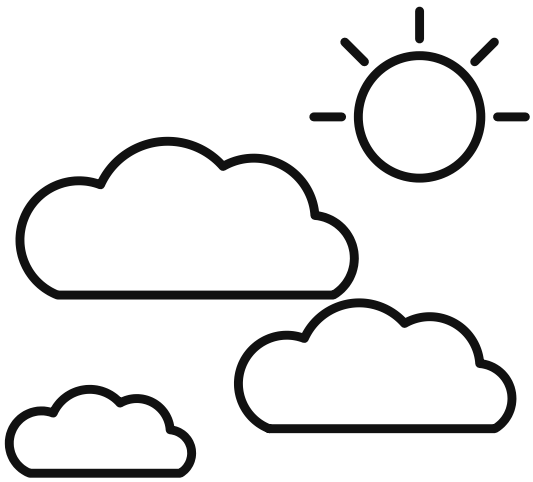
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a long ‘e’ as in “they” (with no ‘y’ at the end)

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ເ = ເກ

gee · long · the sign goes **before** the consonant



ເອ IS FOR

ເມກ

meek

clouds

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ແອ

sa-la ae

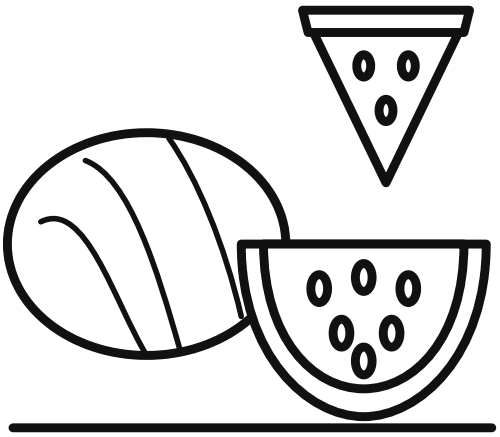
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a long ‘a’ as in “cat”

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ແ◌ = ແກ

gae · long · the sign goes **before** the consonant



ແອ IS FOR

ແຕ໋ງໂມ

dtaeng-moo

watermelon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ໂ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ໂ

sa-la oo

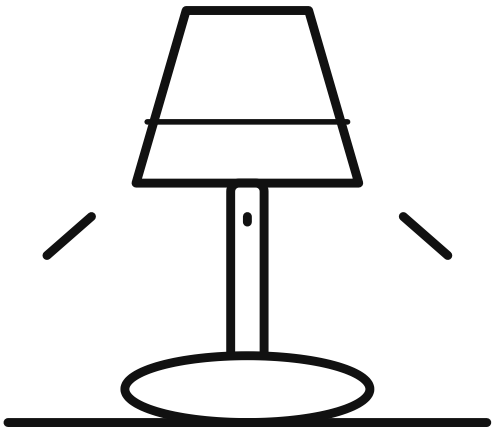
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a long ‘o’ as in “go” (with no ‘w’ at the end)

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ໂ = ໂກ

goo · long · the sign goes **before** the consonant



ໂ IS FOR

ໂຄມໄຟ

khoom-fai

lamp

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ໂ ໂ ໂ ໂ

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◌ໍ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ອໍ

sa-la aw

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

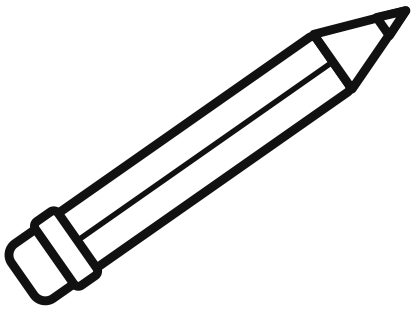
a long ‘aw’ as in “saw”

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ໍ = ກໍ

gaw · long · the sign goes **above** the consonant

With a letter after it, the sign changes to ອ: ກ + ອ + ນ = ກອນ.



ອໍ IS FOR

ດິນສໍ

din-saw

pencil

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ເອຍ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ເອຍ

sa-la ia

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

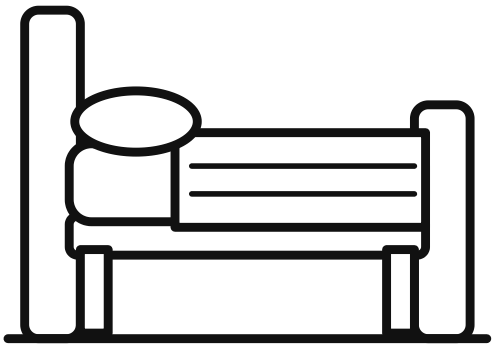
'ee-a', sliding together, as in "Mia"

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ເ◌ຍ = ເກຍ

gia · long · the sign goes **around (before and after)** the consonant

With a letter after it, the sign changes to ◌ຽ: ຕ + ຽ + ງ = ຕຽງ.



ເອຍ IS FOR

ຕຽງ

dtiang

bed

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ເອີ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ເອີ

sa-la eua

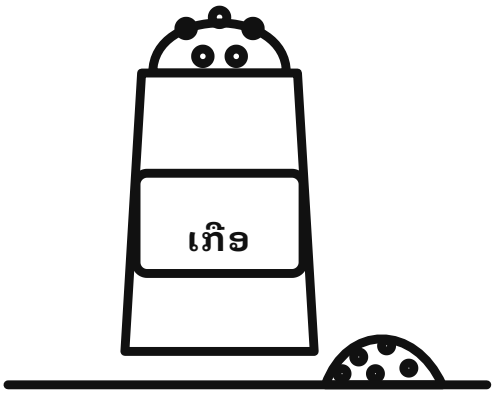
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

the smiling ‘eu’ sliding into ‘a’

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ີ + ◌ອ = ເກີ

geua · long · the sign goes **around (before and after)** the consonant



ເອີ IS FOR

ເກີ

geua

salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ອົວ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ອົວ

sa-la ua

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

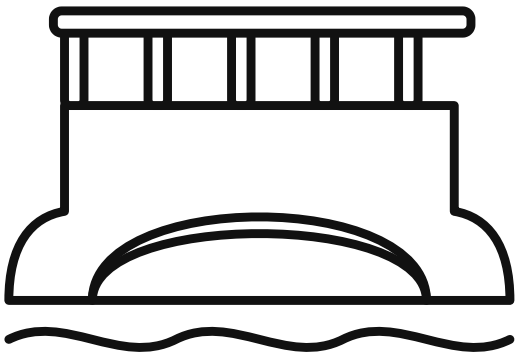
‘oo-a’, sliding together

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ົວ = ກົວ

gua · long · the sign goes **above and after** the consonant

With a letter after it, the sign shrinks to ວ: ກ + ວ + ນ = ກວນ.



ອົວ IS FOR

ຂົວ

khua

bridge

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

ອົວ ອົວ ອົວ ອົວ

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◌ໍາ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ອຳ

sa-la am

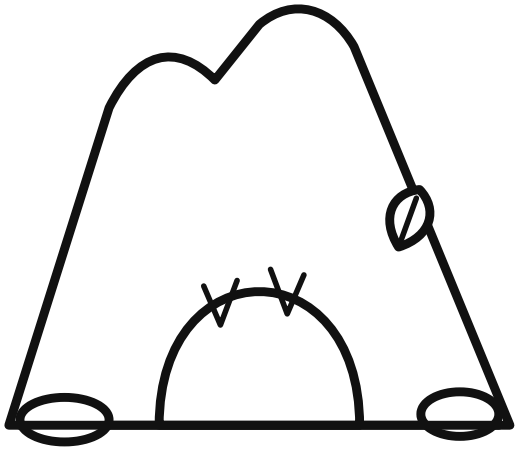
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'am' as in "hum"

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ໍາ = ກໍາ

gam · short · the sign goes **after** the consonant



ອຳ IS FOR

ຖ້ຳ

tham

cave

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ໄອ

sa-la ai (mai ma-lai)

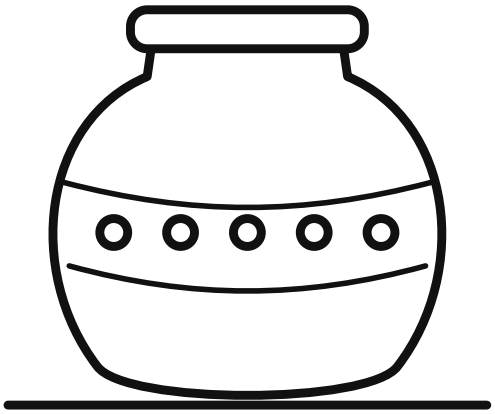
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ai' as in "eye"

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ໄ = ໄກ

gai · short · the sign goes **before** the consonant



ໄອ IS FOR

ໄຫ

hai

big clay jar

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ໃ ໃອ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ໃອ

sa-la ai (mai muan)

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

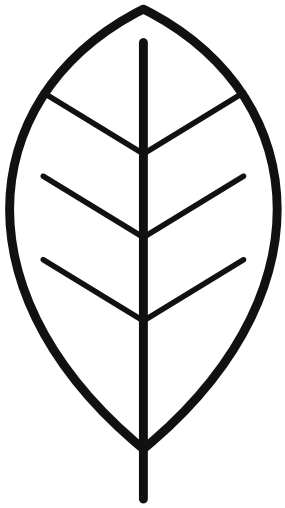
'ai' as in "eye" — the same sound as ໄ

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ໃ◌ = ໃກ

gai · short · the sign goes **before** the consonant

ໃ is used in only about 20 Lao words — learn them one by one!



ໃອ IS FOR

ໃບໄມ້

bai-mai

leaf

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

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ເອົາ

NAME · ຊື່

ສະຫຼະ ເອົາ

sa-la ao

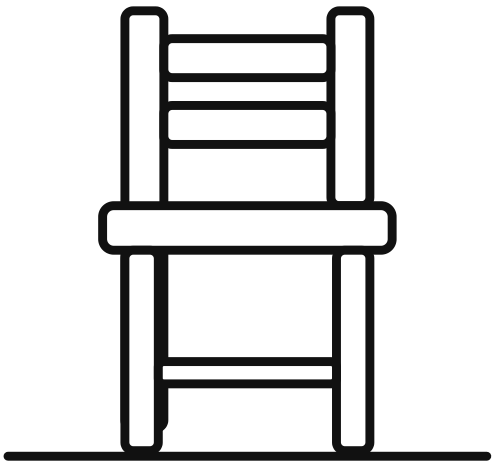
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'ao' as in "now"

LAO PHONETICS · VOWEL SIGN

ກ + ◌ົາ = ກົາ

gao · short · the sign goes **around (before and after)** the consonant



ເອົາ IS FOR

ເກົ້າອີ້

gao-ii

chair

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ຂຽນ

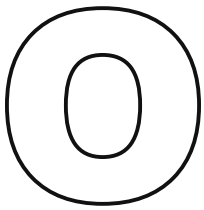
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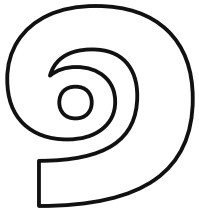
BONUS

Lao numbers ຕົວເລກລາວ *(dtua-leek laao)*

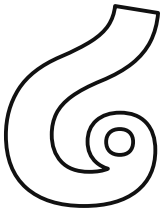
Color the numbers and count out loud in Lao: *suun*, *neung*, *sawng*, *saam*...



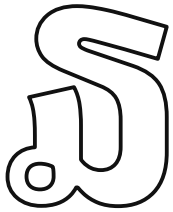
0
ສູນ
suun
zero



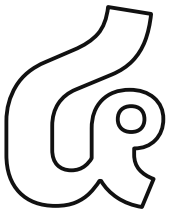
1
ໜຶ່ງ
neung
one



2
ສອງ
sawng
two



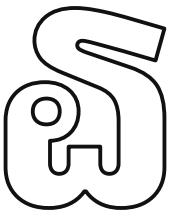
3
ສາມ
saam
three



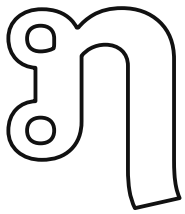
4
ສີ່
sii
four



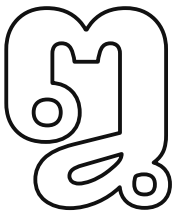
5
ຫ້າ
haa
five



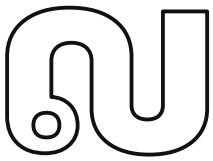
6
ຫົກ
hok
six



7
ເຈັດ
jet
seven



8
ແປດ
bpaet
eight



9
ເກົ້າ
gao
nine

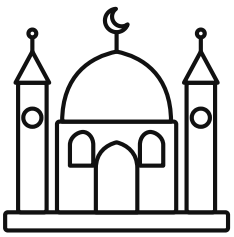
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LET'S TALK

My first Lao words ຄຳທຳອິດຂອງຂ້ອຍ

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

ອັສສະລາມຸອະລັຍກຸມ	*as-sa-laa-mu a-lai-kum* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
ວະອະລັຍກຸມຸສສະລາມ	*wa a-lai-ku-mus-sa-laam* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
ສະບາຍດີ	*sa-baai-dii* **Hello!**
ຂ້ອຍຊື່ ...	*khoi seuu ...* **My name is ...**
ຂອບໃຈ	*khawp-jai* **Thank you**
ຢະຊາກັລລໍຮຸ ໄຄຣັນ	*ja-zaa-gal-laa-hu khai-ran* **May Allah reward you with good**
ແມ່ · ພໍ່	*mae · phaw* **Mother · Father**
ອ້າຍ · ເອື້ອຍ	*aai · euay* **Big brother · Big sister**
ແມ່ນ · ບໍ່	*maen · baw* **Yes · No**
ຂ້ອຍກຳລັງຮຽນພາສາລາວ!	*khoi gam-lang hian phaa-saa laao!* **I am learning Lao!**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

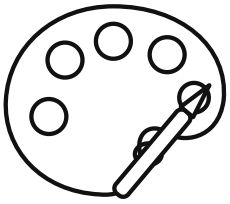
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International): first- and second-language speakers of Lao.

What's next?
You have met all **46 Lao letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Lao, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ມາຊາອັລລໍ! ເກ່ັງຫຼາຍ!

maa-saa-al-law! geng laai! — Mashallah! Well done!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 46 letters of the Lao alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

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